

Chapter 9-1

"What is misfortune value?" Liang Shi asked in her mind, hoping the system would give her an answer.

But there was none.

The atmosphere in the room was like ice, with the two sisters sulking at each other.

It was so quiet you could hear a pin drop.

"What is Level 1 punishment?" Liang Shi asked again.

The system still didn't answer.

Liang Shi felt uneasy, her eyes scanning every corner of the room, confirming there was no fourth person in this room, and the windows were tightly closed, so no one should be able to jump in through the windows.

While she was nervous, Xu Qingya's clear voice rang out, "Liang jiejie, your hand..."

Hearing this, Liang Shi raised her hand and saw a very long bloody gash on her palm, bleeding outward. Blood drops formed and fell to the ground. When she hadn't noticed this wound, she felt no pain, but once she saw it, she felt like the flesh of her palm was being cut by a blade, and that voice kept replaying in her mind.

It was truly both physical and mental torture.

Was this Level 1 punishment?

Liang Shi's frown deepened. She often got injured while filming, and having been sick for so long, she had become her own doctor. Her first reaction after seeing blood was to put her hand behind her back, gently curling her fingers back into her palm, but it hurt too much to curl them back.

She smiled weakly, "It's nothing, you two talk, I'll go treat the wound."

"You seem to be seriously injured." Xu Qingya came over with concern, "I'll go with you."

"No need, you chat with your sister for a while." Liang Shi said: "I'll just find a pharmacy to bandage it casually."

After saying this, she glanced at Xu Qingzhu and found her looking over with an inquiring gaze.

Their eyes met.

Liang Shi looked away first.

Her palm wound wasn't completely inexplicable. On the night she transmigrated, to avoid marking the Omega in heat and keep herself clear-headed, she had cut her palm with a utility knife.

But that cut was definitely not this long or this deep.

The doctor had already bandaged it for her, and her palm only had a band-aid on it.

Liang Shi's palm was in unbearable pain. She turned to leave, not forgetting to remind them, "Call me when you're done talking."

Before she could exit, Xu Qingzhu stood up, her voice clear and cold, "I'll go with you."

Liang Shi refused, "No need."

But Xu Qingzhu didn't listen, walking forward to grab her other uninjured hand, "Let's go."

An Omega's hand was smaller than an Alpha's, and Xu Qingzhu was thin. That hand with a hint of coolness was unexpectedly placed in Liang Shi's palm, fingers touching her palm.

Her palm suddenly became burning hot.

Liang Shi turned to look at Xu Qingzhu.

She was tall for an Omega at 166cm, while Liang Shi was 173cm.

At this moment, Xu Qingzhu slightly raised her head, showing a smile on that cold face, her eyes curved like crescents, fingertips gently tracing across Liang Shi's palm, her voice deliberately softened, "I'll go with you."

Liang Shi's ears suddenly turned completely red.

Even though she had held hands while acting, it felt completely different from now.

She even had the illusion that this was her girlfriend.

They would love each other for life, staying together until old age.

"Let's go." Seeing her not moving, Xu Qingzhu shook her arm, "What are you standing there for?"

Only then did Liang Shi come to her senses, "Okay."

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It was windy outside, looking like it was about to rain heavily.

The wind blew Liang Shi somewhat clear-headed.

And as soon as Xu Qingzhu entered the elevator, she let go of her hand and withdrew her smile, standing far away from her.

She only occasionally glanced at her injured hand with her peripheral vision.

Liang Shi knew she was acting, performing for Xu Qingya to see.

It's just that this actress's acting skills were still immature. She only focused on blindly showing affection but forgot about the given circumstances.

Seeing a loved one injured should bring anxiety and fear, but Xu Qingzhu's face showed no emotion at all.

Her acting skills still needed improvement.

Liang Shi didn't expose her. She quietly played the role of a tool person.

There was a large pharmacy right across from the hotel. When Liang Shi was about to cross the street to buy medicine, she was stopped by Xu Qingzhu, "I'll go, you wait..."

She pointed to a bench by the roadside, "over there for me."

Liang Shi was always embarrassed to trouble others. She often got injured on set before and was used to being independent.

She shook her head, "No need, I'll go myself."

But Xu Qingzhu didn't waste words, directly crossing the street, while Liang Shi silently followed behind her.

Entering the pharmacy, Xu Qingzhu expertly found disinfectant, cotton swabs, and gauze. After paying, she carried the medical supplies and left, walking to the bench closest to the pharmacy before stopping.

She sat there, the wind blowing her bright yellow dress, those indifferent eyes without warmth, yet attracting many people's attention.

Almost achieving a 100% head-turning rate.

"That Omega is so beautiful."

"Indeed, I really want to ask for her contact information."

"Don't even think about it, she clearly has an Alpha."

"..."

Fragments of passersby's discussions occasionally reached Liang Shi's ears, but she only glanced slightly before looking away.

Chapter 9-2

At this moment, Liang Shi couldn't focus on anything.

She just wanted to figure out what misfortune value was. Was it a curse from fate or had she done something wrong?

Why did she have to bear so much for no reason?

This garbage system.

Liang Shi cursed a few times in her heart, thinking about this matter so intently that she didn't hear Xu Qingzhu calling her.

Until Xu Qingzhu gently pushed her, "Give me your hand."

Only then did Liang Shi come back to her senses. She slowly extended her hand, saying in a low voice: "Sorry."

Xu Qingzhu's fingers holding her hand suddenly tightened, and she looked up at her thoughtfully.

Liang Shi was thinking about other things and didn't notice.

Xu Qingzhu then took out cotton swabs with an expressionless face to clean the blood from her palm.

The pain brought Liang Shi slightly back to her senses, and she lowered her head to look at the serious Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu's technique for treating wounds was very professional, with just the right amount of pressure. It was clear she was someone who often treated wounds.

But Xu Qingzhu had loving parents and a good family background. Even when the Xu family enterprise was in crisis and on the verge of bankruptcy, her parents never let her suffer any grievance.

Marrying the original body was something Xu Qingzhu had actively proposed.

No matter how worthless the original body was, she wouldn't resort to domestic violence... right?

While Liang Shi was lost in wild thoughts, Xu Qingzhu suddenly asked: "What are you thinking about?"

"You seem very skilled at bandaging wounds." Liang Shi said what she was thinking.

Xu Qingzhu's hand paused, and she laughed very softly.

Her long hair hung by her face, the corners of her mouth curved in a pleased arc. Even though only her profile was visible, it was enough to make people fall for her.

Liang Shi was dazed for a moment, then thought: Truly worthy of being the novel's female lead.

"Is there something funny?" Liang Shi was afraid people would see through her face-obsessed¹ nature, so she cleared her throat.

Xu Qingzhu restrained her smile, her voice becoming cold again, "Nothing."

As soon as she finished speaking, that mechanical system voice suddenly rang in Liang Shi's mind:

【Misfortune value is a virtual value created by the Resentment Management Bureau to balance the ecosystem. The higher the value, the more severe the corresponding punishment. It triggers once when accumulated to multiples of 8, and additional punishment is given every three triggers, with no upper limit.】

Liang Shi: "?"

Liang Shi's heart was burning with anger when the system spoke again in a cheap voice: 【Host, please understand, we're all working people, it's not easy.】

"So what did I do wrong?" Liang Shi asked as calmly as possible: "Why was misfortune value triggered?"

This time the system didn't give a vague explanation like it did with luck points, but instead listed a clear itemized bill, like a supermarket receipt.

【Triggering Xu Qingzhu's PTSD² 5

Favoring Xu Qingya 1

Triggering Xu Qingzhu's grievance 1

Triggering Xu Qingzhu's anger 1

Note: Final interpretation rights belong to the Resentment Management Bureau】

Liang Shi: "....."

What kind of garbage system is this?!

"So as long as I make Xu Qingzhu angry, I'll accumulate resentment value?" Liang Shi asked coldly.

System: 【Theoretically speaking, yes.】

Liang Shi was fuming, and before she could speak, the system preemptively tried to soothe her:

【Don't worry, we're just following the rules. You can do whatever you want in the future.】

The system, knowing it was in the wrong, even started acting cute.

【As long as you do your tasks well, this punishment definitely won't happen a second time.】

"What if I don't?" Liang Shi countered.

System: 【...Give us a chance.】

Liang Shi: "?"

System: 【Your luck points have accumulated to ten. We'll immediately give you a small gift: 30,000 RMB.】

Liang Shi: ".....?"

Was this giving her a slap then a sweet treat?

Then her phone vibrated slightly, and sure enough, she received a bank transfer notification from an unknown account, with an attached message: 【Your performance has made your target very satisfied, please keep up the good work! ^-^】

Liang Shi was speechless. She just wanted to smash this system right now!

Screw your little emoticon.

Before she could ask more questions, the system had already fled: 【Other task performers are calling me, I'll go first, keep it up!】

"Keep up my ass." Liang Shi complained.

Meanwhile, Xu Qingzhu, who was helping her bandage the wound, had just tied the final knot of the bandage, even tying it in a bow shape.

It didn't quite match the strong Alpha temperament.

Looking at her target's face, Liang Shi seemed to... calm down her anger a little bit.

But unexpectedly, Xu Qingzhu suddenly raised her head, looking directly at her, red lips slightly parted, "You..."

She paused, the corners of her mouth curving into a smile. Although it was a rhetorical question, she said it with certainty: "You're not Liang Shi, are you?"

Footnotes: ¹ Face-obsessed: "颜控" (yán kòng) - Internet slang referring to someone who is attracted to or judges people primarily based on their appearance/looks ² PTSD: Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder, referring to Xu Qingzhu's trauma from being kidnapped as mentioned in the synopsis